The Water Cycle

Water moves between the land, the sea and the sky. This journey never stops, and it is called the water cycle.

Evaporation

When the sun heats rivers, lakes and the sea, some of the water turns into water vapour. The vapour is a gas, so we cannot see it as it rises into the air.

In Barangay Paraño, the fish pond gets smaller on hot, sunny days because of evaporation.

Remember: the sun drives the whole cycle.

Condensation

High in the sky the air is cold. The water vapour cools and turns back into tiny drops of water.

Clouds form when vapour cools. Tiny droplets join together and the cloud grows darker.

Precipitation

When the drops become too heavy, they fall back to the ground. Water that falls from clouds is called precipitation.

Rain	Snow
Hail	Sleet

The water flows into rivers and the sea, and the cycle begins again.